

AFRICAN PALM CIVET

The secretive and nocturnal African palm civet is the sole member of the Nandiniidae, which is thought to have split from civet and cat-like ancestors 44.5 million years ago.

42–71 cm
16½–28 in



AFRICAN PALM CIVET
Nandinia binotata
This is a very common but shy tree-dwelling species from C. Africa. Though an omnivore, it eats mostly fruits.

CIVETS, GENETS, AND LINSANGS

With most species possessing a boldly patterned coat, the civets and genets (family Viverridae) and the lingsangs (family Prionodontidae) resemble long-tailed cats, but are less specialized meat-eaters. When threatened, these shy and nocturnal animals squirt a jet of foul-smelling fluid from stink glands near the base of the tail.

61–97 cm
24–38 in



BINTURONG
Arctictis binturong

Possessing a prehensile tail, this S.E. Asian species moves methodically through the forest canopy in search of fruits and small animals.

67–84 cm
26–33 in



AFRICAN CIVET
Civettictis civetta

An opportunistic animal, this large, ground-dwelling omnivore lives alone and marks its territory with a strong musky scent.



51–87 cm
20–34 in

MASKED PALM CIVET
Paguma larvata

This agile, solitary, tree-dwelling native of Indochina eats fruits, insects, and small vertebrates.

42–71 cm
16½–28 in



ASIAN PALM CIVET
Paradoxurus hermaphroditus

With a natural range extending from Pakistan to Indonesia, this fruit-loving civet is considered a pest in palm and banana plantations.

long tail for
balance when
climbing trees



COMMON GENET
Genetta genetta

This widespread predator of small mammals and birds occupies scrub and forests of Africa and S. Europe.

49–68 cm
19½–27 in

rows of
black spots

46–52 cm
18–20½ in



SMALL INDIAN CIVET
Viverricula indica

This small ground-dwelling civet inhabits forests, grasslands, and bamboo thickets from Pakistan to China and Indonesia.



43–58 cm
17–23 in

CAPE GENET
Genetta tigrina

This genet is found in eastern South Africa and Lesotho. It eats mostly invertebrates, but will tackle prey as large as geese.



54–77 cm
21½–30 in

MALAY CIVET
Viverra zibellina

Restricted to the tropical forests of Malaysia, Indonesia, and the Philippines, this nocturnal forager mostly hunts for prey on the ground.

soft,
velvety fur



large eyes to
see in the
dark

38–45 cm
15–18 in

BANDED LINSANG
Prionodon linsang

Also called the tiger civet, this shy species lives in tree holes in S.E. Asian jungle, hunting rats, squirrels, lizards, and birds.

long, thick tail